

Working with Ambiguity

Asking clarifying questions early in a project and adapting when requirements shift as more becomes known.

The student can...	Not Yet	Approaching	Proficient	Advanced
...ask clarifying questions early, not the night before something is due.	Goes silent when a project is introduced; sends questions only when the deadline is hours away.	Asks some questions but waits until stuck rather than front-loading key clarifications at the start.	Within the first day or two, asks targeted questions that remove the biggest unknowns before starting.	Anticipates ambiguities before the teacher surfaces them and drafts a working definition to validate early.
...make a stated assumption and keep working when information is incomplete.	Freezes or refuses to proceed without explicit instructions for every step.	Will move forward when told it is okay, but does not name or flag the assumption made.	States the assumption out loud ("I'm treating X as Y — let me know if that's wrong") and keeps working.	Names assumptions, weighs the risk of each, and designs the work so it can adapt quickly if an assumption is wrong.
...adapt when requirements shift mid-project.	Treats a change in scope as a crisis; restarts from scratch or shuts down.	Adjusts the work but needs reassurance before continuing and may discard still-usable material.	Acknowledges the change, identifies which parts of existing work still apply, and updates the plan without drama.	Frames the change as useful data, identifies the delta, adjusts with minimal lost work, and brings the team along.

Proficient = the competency is demonstrated reliably and independently (the target). Advanced = the student extends it unprompted.